



Change of guard: India all-rounder Hardik Pandya will replace Rohit Sharma as captain of the Mumbai Indians in the 2024 Indian Premier League. But Rohit will continue playing for MI. K. R. DEEPAK

shelling out Rs. 11.50 crore for the left-arm pacer, the Royals released and re-signed him for each of the next two auctions for Rs. 8.40 crore and Rs. 3 crore, respectively.

However, two instances this time around showed that the price correction ploy tends to backfire on teams. The first instance was when Punjab Kings failed to re-acquire Shahrukh Khan. Despite letting go of the Tamil Nadu power-hitter, who was signed for Rs. 9 crore in 2022, Punjab Kings chased him even after the Rs 7 crore mark.

But eventually, Gujarat Titans bought him for Rs. 7.40 crore, at 82 per cent of his last year's IPL fees.

The Titans were at the receiving end in the case of Yash Dayal. The left-arm pacer, bought at Rs. 3.20 crore in their debut IPL season in 2022, was released after suffering Rinku Singh's wrath in IPL 2023.

Even though Titans went much higher in their quest to retain Dayal, Royal Challengers Bangalore had the last laugh at the Rs. 5 crore-mark.

The Rohit Sharma trade conspiracy theory

Ever since Hardik Pandya was officially unveiled as the Mumbai Indians captain, the rumour mill has been abuzz with Rohit's possible

trade to another team during the post-auction trading window that began on December 20.

That's not happening? How? Sample this. Rohit's official auction purse is Rs. 15 crore, although he has been officially paid Rs. 16 crore per season since 2022. No team has a remaining purse anywhere close to Rs. 15 crore.

Of the 10 franchises, Delhi



It looks as if Rohit Sharma will guide Hardik Pandya, the captain, in IPL 2024 and will hopefully carry his silken touch with the willow from the World Cup to the IPL.